BRAIN 10

Selank

Synthetic 7-amino-acid peptide: tuftsin (Thr-Lys-Pro-Arg) with Pro-Gly-Pro added to slow breakdown



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide	Anxiety	Small human studies	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Anxiety** — HUMAN
- **Brain connections** — HUMAN
- **Immune signals** — HUMAN
- **GABA signalling** — ANIMAL

Human data are limited. A handful of small Russian studies, published in Russian, mostly without placebo. No trial is registered on ClinicalTrials.gov.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- Small Russian anxiety studies, 2008 to 2015
- Compared with benzodiazepines; no placebo
- No registered trial

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Safety data in people (FDA)
- Half-life in people
- Abuse potential
- Long-term safety

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Selank ▶ GABA receptors ▶ Calming signals ▶ Anxiety

- **In rat brain membranes,** changed GABA binding, likened to benzodiazepines
- **In rats,** nasal doses changed GABA-linked gene activity in hours
- **In lab tests,** slowed enzymes that break down enkephalins
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	Not established in people (nasal in rats)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	No approved product; not on FDA compounding lists
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Anxiety scales (Hamilton, Zung), side-effect scale	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; was Category 2 (nominations withdrawn)
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide policy
EMA	Not authorised
WADA	Not named; S0 status not stated

REFERENCES

1. FDA, bulk drug substances that may present significant safety risks (Category 2), Apr 2026
2. Front Pharmacol, Selank and GABA-linked genes in rats, Feb 2016
3. J Clin Pharmacol, review of phenibut and Selank, Aug 2021

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